

★★★ PIONEER CLASS OF '23 ★★★
AARON J. PUNO
for Ann Arbor School Board

FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE:

**PUNO THANKS ANN ARBOR EDUCATION
ASSOCIATION FOR ENDORSEMENT**

Dear Friends,

I am profoundly honored by the decision of the Ann Arbor Education Association to endorse me as a candidate for Ann Arbor Public Schools Trustee. I thank the AAEA not just for this endorsement but for their continued advocacy for Ann Arbor's teachers, students, and community members. I particularly want to highlight the work of President Fred Klein, Vice-President Tamala Bell, and PAC Chair Nathan Smead; their leadership in this time of crisis serves as an inspiration.

I'm in this race because it's about time someone had the backs of the most vulnerable people in our district. From the teacher paid \$45,000 a year living in a shack in Belleville to the kid in the self-contained classroom at Pioneer – these people have endured enough hardship and been denied respect for too long. As a candidate and as a trustee, I will do my utmost to ensure that their district sees them not as plotted points on a graph or as commodified talking points but as real, hard-working constituents.

I bring to this race the values and perspective of a thirteen year AAPS student. I bring to this race the values of someone who lived through the budget cuts and Kleenex drives of the Snyder Years and the chaotic frenzy of the COVID Pandemic. I bring to this race the values of the son of immigrants, of someone who suffers from a disability, of someone who has witnessed the countless sacrifices of the everyday heroes we call teachers.

I know that these values and perspectives are shared between myself and many members of the AAEA. I intend to deliver not just for them, but for every student, every teacher, every staff member, every parent, and for every shareholder and community member who wills this district to be the destination district it once was. **With the help of all of you, we can once again be a district that truly leads, cares, and inspires.**

Sincerely,

Aaron J. Puno
Candidate for Ann Arbor School Board